

Sunday, 21 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 30° 21°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 27° 16°	MANCHESTER Overcast 25° 16°	GLASGOW Overcast 22° 12°
-------------------------------	-----------------------------------	-----------------------------------	--------------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The number of people critically injured in yesterday's train crash near Bedford has risen, with nine people now fighting for their lives.

Emergency services say a total of 28 people are still in hospital, following the incident that tragically killed the train driver. Investigations into the cause are continuing.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 2

Get ready for another heatwave! An extreme heat warning has been expanded across the UK, with temperatures set to soar again.

After a slightly cooler Saturday, the mercury could hit 36 degrees Celsius by Tuesday. The Met Office has issued an amber extreme heat warning.

WEATHER · UK
- 3

Police are investigating a series of suspected Islamophobic attacks in Edinburgh, which left five people injured.

Two people were hurt near a mosque, and a man was later seen battering the door of a pizzeria. Members of the public were seen running away from the incidents.

CRIME · UK
- 4

Speculation is mounting that support for the Prime Minister, Keir Starmer, is rapidly fading after a significant by-election victory for Andy Burnham.

Political observers suggest that the Labour leader is under increasing pressure to set out a clear timetable for his departure. This comes amid growing calls from within his own party.

POLITICS · UK
- 5

A child attacked by a crocodile at a farm zoo remains in critical condition two days after the terrifying incident.

A 30-year-old man has been bailed in connection with the event, which saw the child end up in the crocodile enclosure. Details surrounding how the child got there are still emerging.

INCIDENT · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Get ready for some serious sparkle on the dancefloor! Kim Kardashian's hair stylist, Chris Appleton, is joining the Strictly Come Dancing line-up.**

The British stylist is renowned for working with A-listers like Jennifer Lopez, Katy Perry, and Ariana Grande. He's sure to bring some Hollywood glamour to the ballroom.

ON AIR – Who do you think Chris will be partnered with, and will his dance moves be as sharp as his haircuts?

TV · COMING UP
- 2 Singer Jack Savoretti is reflecting on two decades in music and how moving to Oxfordshire helped him navigate a 'midlife crisis'.**

The artist is known for his soulful voice and heartfelt lyrics. He's been sharing insights into his creative process and personal journey.

ON AIR – What's a big life change that's inspired you or helped you through a tough time?

MUSIC · NOW
- 3 Exciting news for history and art lovers! The new London Museum Smithfield site is set to open its doors this November.**

The impressive new building will house fascinating exhibits, including some of Banksy's piranhas and the UK's oldest hand-written document. It promises to be a major cultural attraction.

ON AIR – Which museum exhibit are you most looking forward to seeing at the new London Museum?

CULTURE · COMING UP
- 4 Zara Larsson electrified the crowd at Big Weekend in Sunderland, delivering a high-energy performance that had everyone dancing.**

The Swedish pop star treated festival-goers to a string of her biggest hits. She was one of the standout acts on day two of the popular event.

ON AIR – What's the best live performance you've seen recently, and who was it?

MUSIC · WEEKEND
- 5 The stars of the new film 'Your Fault: London' are discussing the challenges of depicting complex relationships, including a romance between step-siblings.**

They've been talking about the film's dedicated BookTok fandom and the fine line between romanticising and exploring toxic relationships. It's certainly a conversation starter.

ON AIR – What's a film or book that made you think differently about a tricky subject?

FILM · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 Scotland's World Cup hopes remain alive despite a narrow defeat to a classy Morocco side, who scored just 71 seconds into the game.**

The Tartan Army showed great resilience after a nightmare start. Their chances of a historic knock-out place now rest on their final group game.

ON AIR – After that tough start, how do you rate Scotland's chances of making it through to the next round?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP
- 2 A World Cup first: Paraguay's Miguel Almiron has become the first player to be sent off for covering his mouth while speaking to an opponent.**

The incident happened during Paraguay's match against Turkey, under new rules designed to prevent players from hiding their words. It's certainly a talking point for the tournament.

ON AIR – Do you think these new rules about covering mouths are a good idea, or do they go too far?

FOOTBALL · WORLD CUP
- 3 England are feeling the heat in the third Test against New Zealand, who are now in complete control at The Oval.**

New Zealand finished day three with a commanding lead of 352 runs, with Henry Nicholls unbeaten on 119. They still have seven wickets in hand, making it a tough challenge for England.

ON AIR – Can England still turn this Test match around, or is New Zealand too far ahead?

CRICKET · UK
- 4 Wales are reportedly eyeing former Nottingham Forest boss Steve Cooper as a potential successor to head coach Craig Bellamy.**

Bellamy is being linked with a move to Burnley, prompting Wales to prepare a shortlist of replacements. It could be a significant change for the national team.

ON AIR – Who would you like to see take the reins for Wales if Craig Bellamy moves on?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 British heavyweight Moses Itauma is set for his biggest test yet, as he's confirmed to face Filip Hrgovic in August at London's O2 Arena.**

This highly anticipated bout will be a major step up for Itauma, who is looking to make his mark in the heavyweight division. It promises to be an exciting night of boxing.

ON AIR – How do you think Moses Itauma will fare against Filip Hrgovic in what's a huge fight for him?

BOXING · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that 'micro-breaks' can significantly boost productivity and overall well-being at work.**
Taking just five to ten minutes away from your desk to stretch, get a drink, or simply stare out the window can refresh your mind and improve focus for the rest of the day.
- 2 The trend for 'upcycled fashion' is growing, with more people transforming old clothes into stylish new outfits.**
From customising denim jackets to repurposing vintage fabrics, it's a creative way to be sustainable and express personal style without buying new.
- 3 Research indicates that 'listening to classical music' can improve concentration during complex tasks.**
Scientists found that instrumental pieces, particularly those without lyrics, create a calming background that helps some people focus better on their work or studies.
- 4 There's a growing interest in 'urban foraging', where city dwellers learn to identify edible plants in their local parks and green spaces.**
It's a quirky way to connect with nature, learn about local flora, and even add some wild ingredients to your meals, always ensuring you know exactly what you're picking!
- 5 A new report highlights the benefits of 'daily journaling' for mental clarity and emotional regulation.**
Taking a few minutes each day to write down thoughts and feelings can help reduce stress, process emotions, and even spark new ideas.
- 6 The popularity of 'indoor gardening' is flourishing, with more people creating green havens inside their homes.**
Whether it's a window herb garden or a collection of exotic houseplants, bringing nature indoors can improve air quality and provide a calming aesthetic.
- 7 Experts are noting a rise in 'community repair cafes', where volunteers help fix broken household items for free.**
From toasters to torn clothes, these cafes promote sustainability, reduce waste, and build community spirit by sharing practical skills.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'tidying' what when we're visiting someone else's house?

ANSWER: THEIR WONKY STACK OF MAGAZINES OR SLIGHTLY ASKEW CUSHIONS!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a specific 'voice' or 'accent' we put on when we're talking to our pets. What is it?

ANSWER: A RIDICULOUSLY HIGH-PITCHED, BABY-TALK VOICE THAT WE'D NEVER USE IN PUBLIC!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a new 'flavour combination' that just instantly blows your mind and you wonder where it's been all your life?

What's the most surprising or unusual food pairing you've tried that turned out to be absolutely delicious? Give us a call and tell us all about it!

- We all have those certain 'everyday sounds' that, for whatever reason, we find incredibly satisfying or calming.

What's an everyday sound that you just love to hear? Is it the kettle boiling, rain on the window, or perhaps the rustle of a newspaper? Share your sonic joys with us!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a parliament?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights can sometimes be heard, making a faint crackling or hissing sound.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£42 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£42 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils and can be stored indefinitely, thanks to its unique chemical composition.
- The longest place name in the world is Taumatawhakatangihangakoauauotamateaturipukakapikimaungahoronukupokaiwhenuakitanatahu, a hill in New Zealand.
- A jiffy is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The human eye can distinguish approximately 10 million different colours.
- Flamingos get their pink colour from the beta-carotene in the brine shrimp and algae they eat.
- The world's smallest mammal is the bumblebee bat, found in Thailand and Myanmar.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.

On this day

Day 172 of the year, 193 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alban of Mainz; Christian feast day: Aloysius Gonzaga; Christian feast day: Engelmund of Velsen; Christian feast day: John Rigby. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Kris Allen, American musician, singer and songwriter
- 1964 — Dean Saunders, Welsh footballer and manager
- 1944 — Ray Davies, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1951 — Alan Hudson, English footballer
- 1964 — Doug Savant, American actor
- 1970 — Eric Reed, American pianist and composer
- 1992 — MAX, American singer, songwriter, actor, dancer and model
- 1947 — Michael Gross, American actor

THE DAY TODAY

- 2006 — Pluto's newly discovered moons are officially named Nix and Hydra.
- 1964 — Three civil rights workers, Andrew Goodman, James Chaney and Michael Schwerner, are murdered in Neshoba County, Mississippi, United States, by members of the Ku Klux Klan.
- 1970 — Penn Central declares Section 77 bankruptcy in what was the largest U.S. corporate bankruptcy to date.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1978 — The original production of Tim Rice and Andrew Lloyd Webber's musical, Evita, based on the life of Eva Perón, opens at the Prince Edward Theatre, London.
- 1942 — World War II: Tobruk falls to Italian and German forces; 33,000 Allied troops are taken prisoner.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2000 — Section 28 (of the Local Government Act 1988), outlawing the 'promotion' of homosexuality in the United Kingdom, is repealed in Scotland with a 99 to 17 vote.
- 1973 — In its decision in Miller v. California, 413 U.S. 15, the Supreme Court of the United States establishes the Miller test for determining whether something is obscene and not protected speech under the U.S. constitution.

- 2025 — A hot air balloon catches fire mid-flight and crashes in Praia Grande, Santa Catarina, Brazil, killing 8 of the 21 on board.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 173 of the year, 192 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron of Aleth; Christian feast day: Alban, first recorded Martyr in Britain (commemoration, Anglicanism); Christian feast day: Blessed Pope Innocent V; Christian feast day: Eusebius of Samosata (Catholic and Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1974 — Donald Faison, American actor
- 1954 — Freddie Prinze, American comedian and actor (died 1977)
- 1961 — Jimmy Somerville, Scottish singer-songwriter
- 1940 — Esther Rantzen, English journalist
- 1992 — Harry Reid, British actor
- 1949 — Lindsay Wagner, American actress
- 1950 — Tom Alter, Indian actor (died 2017)
- 1950 — Sharon Maughan, English actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1942 — World War II: Erwin Rommel is promoted to Field Marshal after the Axis capture of Tobruk.
- 2025 — The United States conducts airstrikes on three Iranian nuclear sites in Fordow, Natanz, and Isfahan.
- 2012 — Paraguayan President Fernando Lugo is removed from office by impeachment and succeeded by Federico Franco.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1969 — The Cuyahoga River catches fire in Cleveland, Ohio, drawing national attention to water pollution, and spurring the passing of the Clean Water Act and the creation of the Environmental Protection Agency.
- 1948 — The ship HMT Empire Windrush brought the first group of 802 West Indian immigrants to Tilbury, marking the start of modern immigration to the United Kingdom.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)